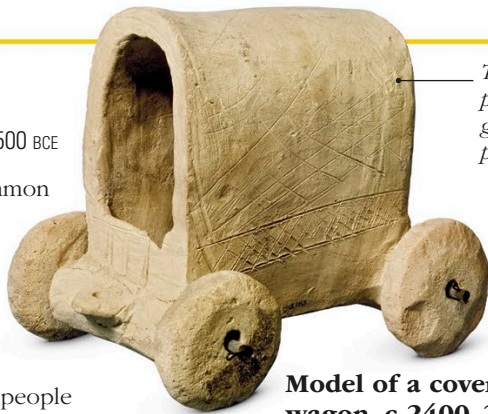


Trade wagon

- **What?** Covered wagon
- **Who?** Unknown
- **Where and when?** Eurasia, c. 2500 BCE

Four-wheeled wagons were common across Europe and Asia by 2500 BCE. Hitched to teams of powerful animals, they could transport very heavy loads. Such wagons had a protective cover and were ideal for use by people trading goods or riding as passengers.



The cover protected the goods or passengers.

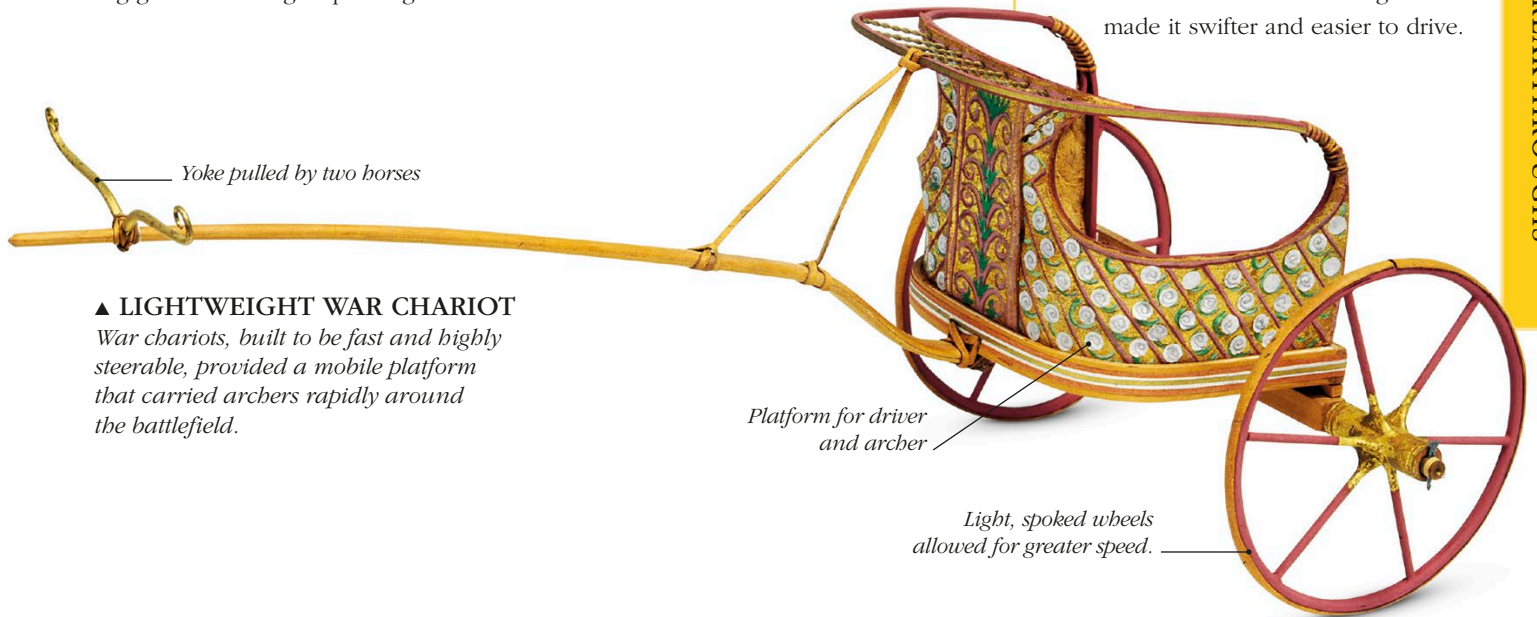
Model of a covered wagon, c. 2400–2300 BCE

Egyptian chariot

- **What?** Two-wheeled chariot
- **Who?** Unknown
- **Where and when?** Egypt, c. 1600 BCE

Chariots were the racing cars of the ancient world. These small, two-wheeled, horse-drawn vehicles usually carried just two people. The Mesopotamians were the first to develop chariots, but the Egyptians made improvements by using spoked wheels instead of solid wooden ones.

This reduced the vehicle's weight and made it swifter and easier to drive.



Yoke pulled by two horses

▲ LIGHTWEIGHT WAR CHARIOT

War chariots, built to be fast and highly steerable, provided a mobile platform that carried archers rapidly around the battlefield.

Platform for driver and archer

Light, spoked wheels allowed for greater speed.



Coach services

- **What?** Stagecoach
- **Who?** Unknown
- **Where and when?** Europe, 17th century CE

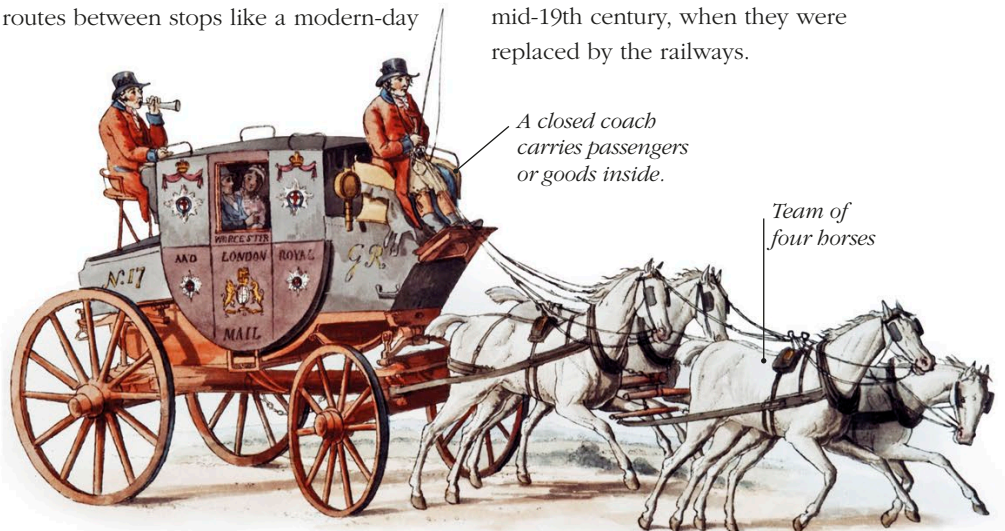
The stagecoach, which first appeared in Britain, provided regular services over set routes between stops like a modern-day

bus. With their shock-absorbing springs, and traveling on improved roads, coaches offered a less bumpy ride than earlier vehicles. Stagecoaches remained an important form of transport until the mid-19th century, when they were replaced by the railways.

Carriage

- **What?** *Raeda*
- **Who?** Unknown
- **Where and when?** Rome, 2nd century BCE

The Romans built a road network across their empire. For traveling, they used the *raeda*, a four-wheeled vehicle pulled by up to 10 horses or mules. This could carry several passengers and their luggage, taking loads of around 750lb (350kg) and covering up to 15 miles (25km) a day.



A closed coach carries passengers or goods inside.

Team of four horses

Engraving of a stagecoach, 19th century